[CHARLES BURGESS TO HIS PARENTS.] *Camp two days march from Tabreez*
September 13, 1829

Just 20 months ago I wrote you a letter in which I mentioned all my affairs as settled and myself as established in the Princes service, this turned out very differently. When the Prince returned from a journey to Teheran his affairs were in a very bad state the debt to the Russians[8] in a great measure unpaid and the regular army could not that year be collected. Under these circumstances he decided upon not accepting us and broke his agreements and every thing else, notwithstanding the repeated remonstrances of Major Hart, the Ambassador etc. At this time there came to Tabreez a Coordish Pacha whose country lies midway between Tabreez and Bagdad, he wishing to introduce discipline into his army applied for us and we entered into an agreement with him, that is to say a Mr. Christian nephew of Dr. Cormick and myself and started with him for his country *Sulimanieh,* during this time I particularly avoided writing to you as the country I was placed in is considered dangerous for Franks even to pass through and I did not wish you to be under unnecessary alarms, and hoped and believed I should soon return to the Princes service which has eventually turned out to be the case. We served Mahmoud Pacha for a period of nine months much to his satisfaction and were treated by him like his own sons, at the end of this time while the Pacha and ourselves were out engaged in a war with the Rewandoos a neighbouring people his brother Governor of the country during his absence became a traitor and with the assistance of an army from Bagdad succeeded in turning him out of his country, and we all came together to the Prince Abbas Mirza encamped here. I was particularly well received, was told he had heard an excellent character of me, and desired my services, to which I of course assented and am now if no new misfortune takes place in his service but he has cheated us in pay which he has docked down in pay from 500 to 400 tomauns pleading the distressed state of finances and promising after a year to increase us. If this lasts I am satisfied. We are now in a camp with 7000 disciplined troops artillery etc. gaining much useful information and satisfied that in this country with great industry and application there is every probability of ultimately doing something. I now speak the language fluently, have travelled much, been in many dangers and difficulties from which I have happily escaped with an unimpaired constitution and although severely wounded some time back now completely recovered. From Coordistan we thought ourselves happy to get off with our necks whole and our little stock of money, leaving all our other baggage to the conquerors. I of course have many long stories to tell of adventures but now have not a moment to spare. I will now write constantly pray let

[8] The war indemnity imposed by the victorious Russians.

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